

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86ROME 025093

ADP380
SECRET

PAGE 01 ROME 25093 01 OF 04 201916Z
ACTION SS-00

INFO LOG-00 ADS-00 SSD-00 /000 W
-----336116 201917Z /38

O 201858Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY ROME
TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 6106
SECDEF WASHDC IMMEDIATE
USCINCEUR VAIHINGEN GE//ECJ-5// IMMEDIATE

S E C R E T SECTION 01 OF 04 ROME 25093

EXDIS

MILADDEES TREAT AS SPECAT EXCLUSIVE

SECDEF FOR DAS J. MARESCA

USCINCEUR FOR MG CRAIG

E.O. 12356 DECL: OADR
TAGS: *PARM, PTER, MARR, MASS, MCAP, IT, US, UR, LY
SUBJECT: SECRETARY WEINBERGER'S OCTOBER 18 MEETING
WITH DEFENSE MINISTER SPADOLINI

1. (S) ENTIRE TEXT.)

2. SUMMARY:

SECRETARY WEINBERGER AND DEFENSE MINISTER SPADOLINI MET IN
FORMAL SESSIONS WITH THEIR RESPECTIVE DELEGATIONS OCTOBER
18 FOR ONE AN HOUR. SECRETARY WEINBERGER DISCUSSED THE
PRESIDENT'S REYKJAVIK MEETING WITH GORBACHEV AND THE
PRESIDENT'S ARMS CONTROL PROPOSALS.

END SUMMARY.

3. T

EXCISE

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EXDIS REVIEW

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Cat. B - Transferred to
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11/21/89

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVIEWED by SEA DATE 11/21/89
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4. REYKJAVIK

SECRETARY WEINBERGER SAID THE MAJOR ISSUES AT REYKJAVIK WERE THE ARMS CONTROL ISSUES BEING NEGOTIATED IN GENEVA. THE PRESIDENT RAISED REGIONAL ISSUES SUCH AS AFGHANISTAN AND KAMPUCHEA, AS WELL AS HUMAN RIGHTS ISSUES. GORBACHEV.

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HOWEVER, **HAD ONLY WANTED TO TALK ABOUT ARMS CONTROL. SECRETARY WEINBERGER REVIEWED PRESIDENT REAGAN'S ARMS CONTROL PROPOSALS. THE SECRETARY SAID NO ONE REALLY KNOWS WHAT THE NEXT STEPS WILL BE. AS HE HAD TOLD PRESIDENT COSSIGA EARLIER, THERE APPEARS TO BE CONFUSION ON THE SOVIET SIDE IN CONNECTION WITH LINKAGE ON INF AND SOI. SO FAR, AS THE U.S. CAN TELL, THE SOVIET POSITION APPEARS TO BE THAT THE U.S. MUST GIVE UP AND KILL THE SOI PROGRAM AS A CONDITION FOR AGREEMENT TO REDUCE OFFENSIVE NUCLEAR WEAPONS. THIS IS UNACCEPTABLE TO THE PRESIDENT. THE SECRETARY SAID HE FELT THE SOVIETS WERE TESTING THE PRESIDENT. THAT HAS BEEN DONE BEFORE, WITHOUT SUCCESS.

5. SPAOLINI ASKED WHETHER THE U.S. HAD GONE TO REYKJAVIK HOPING THAT SOVIET OPPOSITION TO SDI WAS NOT SO STRONG. SECRETARY WEINBERGER REPLIED THAT WE HAD HOPED THE SOVIETS WERE PREPARED FOR SERIOUS AGREEMENT. THE PRESIDENT WAS ALWAYS READY TO GO ANYWHERE TO SEEK A VERIFIABLE ARMS PRODUCTION AGREEMENT. IN THE BEGINNING THERE WERE HOPES OF PROGRESS AT REYKJAVIK, BUT AT THE LAST MINUTE THE SOVIETS LINKED ALL PROGRESS TO SDI. THE PRESIDENT WAS SIMPLY UNPREPARED TO ACCEPT THEIR CONDITIONS. SECRETARY WEINBERGER SAID THE PRESIDENT ALSO WENT TO ICELAND IN THE HOPE OF SETTING A DATE FOR GORBACHEV'S VISIT TO THE U.S. THERE NOW APPEARS TO BE LITTLE HOPE OF SUCH A

MEETING IN THE NEAR FUTURE.

6. SECRETARY WEINBERGER SAID THAT THE SOVIETS WANT TO INCREASE PUBLIC PRESSURE ON THE PRESIDENT TO ABANDON SDI.

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TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 6107
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USCINCEUR VAHINGEN GE//ECU-5// IMMEDIATE

S E C R E T SECTION 02 OF 04 ROME 25093

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MILADRES TREAT AS SPECAT EXCLUSIVE

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THEY ARE MAKING A MISTAKE IN HIS VIEW, SINCE PUBLIC OPINION
POLLS IN THE U.S. SHOW SUPPORT FOR THE PRESIDENT TO BE
VERY HIGH. THE AMERICAN PUBLIC WANTS PROTECTION AGAINST
A NUCLEAR ATTACK. IT HAS NEVER FULLY ACCEPTED THE IDEA THAT
ONE IS COMPLETELY SAFE WHEN HE IS COMPLETELY VULNERABLE.

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TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86ROME 025093

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TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 6108
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USCINCEUR VAHINGEN GE//ECJ-5// IMMEDIATE
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MILADDS TREAT AS SPECAT EXCLUSIVE
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SECDEF FOR DAS J. MARESCA

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- Row 1: 10 dots
- Row 2: 10 dots
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PAGE 01 ROME 25093 04 OF 04 201919Z
ACTION SS-00

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FM AMEMBASSY ROME
TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 6109
SECDEF WASHDC IMMEDIATE
USCINCPAC WASHINGTON GE//ECJ-S// IMMEDIATE

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16. AFTER LUNCH, THERE WAS AN UNEXPECTED QU. 2-HOUR
PRIVATE MEETING BETWEEN HIS HOLINESS POPE JOHN PAUL II,
THE SECRETARY AND MRS. WEINBERGER, AMB. AND MRS. RABB,
AND MINISTER SPADOLINI. DURING THIS SESSION,
ARRANGED AT THE LAST MINUTE BY SPADOLINI, THE SECRETARY
TOLO THE POPE ABOUT THE DISCUSSIONS AT REYKJAVIK,
NOTING THAT PRESIDENT REAGAN WANTS TO ELIMINATE ALL
OFFENSIVE MISSILES WHILE DEPLOYING A SYSTEM THAT WILL
NOT HARM PEOPLE BUT DESTROY MISSILES IN SPACE. THE

SECRETARY NOTED THAT SOI CANNOT HIT GROUND-BASED TARGETS. WHEN THE TWO SIDES WERE CLOSE TO AN AGREEMENT AT REYKJAVIK ON REDUCTION OF OFFENSIVE NUCLEAR WEAPONS, THE SOVIETS HAD BLOCKED THE NEGOTIATIONS BY LINKING ANY AGREEMENT TO A BAN ON ALL BUT LABORATORY TESTING OF SOI. THE POPE COMMENTED THAT

by a 305

SECDEF SAID THAT PRESIDENT REAGAN DOES NOT PURSUE SOI FOR UNILATERAL ADVANTAGE OR TO ACHIEVE AMERICAN SUPERIORITY. AS EVIDENCE OF THIS, THE PRESIDENT HAD OFFERED TO SHARE THE SOI TECHNOLOGY WHEN ALL OFFENSIVE MISSILES ARE ELIMINATED (THE ZERO OPTION). SECDEF SAID THE PRESIDENT CALLS THIS AN INSURANCE POLICY WHICH WILL PROTECT ALL OF MANKIND AGAINST THE RISK OF SOVIET CHEATING, OR THE POSSIBILITY THAT OTHER NATIONS OR TERRORIST GROUPS WOULD ACQUIRE NUCLEAR WEAPONS.

17. COMMENT: THE SUCCESS OF THE MEETINGS BETWEEN SECRETARY WEINBERGER AND MINISTER SPADOLINI MIMICRED THE GOOD FEELING THAT THE SECRETARY ENCOUNTERED ON ALL HIS OFFICIAL CALLS AS WELL AS THE PUBLIC RESPONSE TO HIS VISIT. BUT THERE WAS MORE THAN GOOD FEELING INVOLVED. THE SECRETARY, WHOSE VISIT CLOSELY FOLLOWED THAT OF SOVIET DEPUTY FOREIGN MINISTER

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BESSMERTNYKH, WAS EXTREMELY EFFECTIVE IN EXPLAINING AND ADVOCATING OUR POST-REYKJAVIK POSITION ON ARMS CONTROL. ITALIAN UNDERSTANDING OF AND SUPPORT FOR THAT POSITION WERE, AS A RESULT, GREATLY STRENGTHENED. END COMMENT.

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